THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — ENGLISH · MID-TERM PRACTICE PAPER

Session 2026–27 · Set 03

Class: VIII | Subject: English | Time: 2½ Hours | Max. Marks: 60

General Instructions:

1. The Question Paper is divided into FOUR sections. Section A: Reading 14 marks; Section B: Grammar 14 marks; Section C: Writing 12 marks; Section D: Literature 20 marks.
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.
3. Marks are indicated against each question.
4. Read the questions carefully before answering.

SECTION A — READING (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q1. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**

The Stepwells of Rajasthan

In the dry lands of Rajasthan, where rain is scarce and rivers are few, people built stepwells known as *baoris* to store water. A stepwell is a deep well with a flight of steps leading down to the water. As the water level rose and fell with the seasons, people simply walked up or down the steps to reach it.

The stepwell at Abhaneri, near Jaipur, has 3,500 narrow steps arranged in perfect patterns and is nearly 20 metres deep. The air at the bottom is about five degrees cooler than outside, so stepwells also became shady meeting places where travellers rested and villagers gathered. Today many stepwells are neglected and filled with garbage, though a few are being restored to protect this wonderful heritage.

1. What is a stepwell? **1**

(a) A tall tower for storing grain
(b) A deep well with steps leading to the water
(c) A canal in the desert
(d) A pond made by rainfall

2. Why did the people of Rajasthan build stepwells? **1**

(a) To store water in a dry region (b) To grow rice
(c) To worship rivers (d) To keep animals

3. Why were stepwells also popular meeting places? **1**

(a) They were close to the market (b) The air at the bottom was cooler
(c) They had musicians (d) They were free of insects

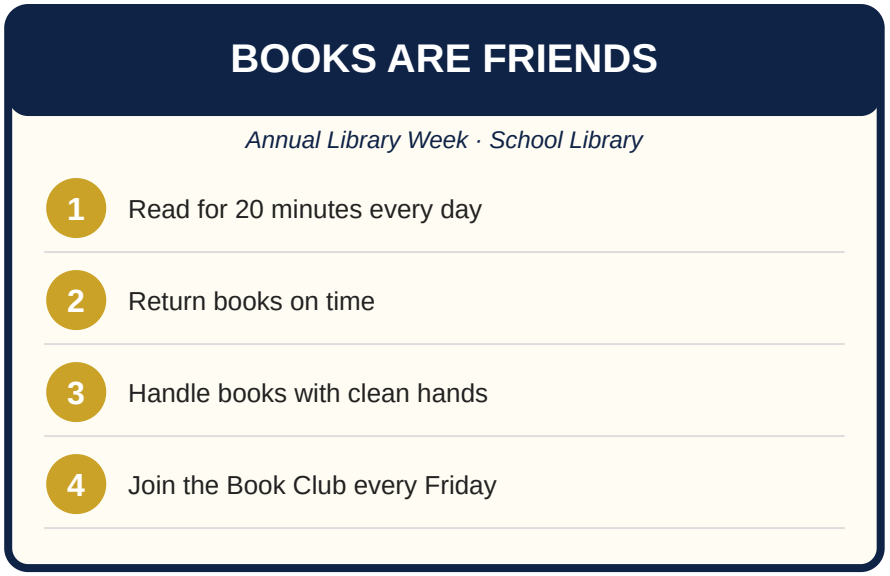
4. The word 'neglected' in the passage means: **1**

(a) Looked after (b) Decorated
(c) Not taken care of (d) Newly built

5. How did people reach water when the level changed with the seasons? Write one sentence. **2**

6. What is being done to protect stepwells today? **1**

Q2. Study the poster carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**



A library is a treasure house of knowledge and imagination. Students who read regularly develop a better vocabulary, concentrate for longer and write with greater confidence. Yet many children spend hours on screens and rarely open a book. School libraries therefore organise reading weeks, book clubs and storytelling sessions to bring back the joy of reading.

1) According to the passage, what do regular readers develop? **1**

(a) Poor eyesight (b) A better vocabulary
(c) A dislike for screens (d) Less homework

2) On which day does the Book Club meet? **1**

(a) Monday (b) Wednesday
(c) Friday (d) Sunday

3) Which poster instruction helps keep the books in good condition? **1**

(a) Read for 20 minutes (b) Handle books with clean hands
(c) Join the Book Club (d) Visit on Friday

4) What does 'treasure house' stand for in the passage? **1**

(a) A bank (b) A place full of valuable things
(c) A school store (d) A museum of coins

5) Why do school libraries organise book clubs and storytelling sessions? Give two points. **2**

6) Name one rule from the poster that you will follow and say why. **1**

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q3. Do as directed.

I. Attempt any 4 from the following questions by choosing the most appropriate options. **(4x1=4)**

1) The meeting was _____ off because of heavy rain.

(a) called (b) called out
(c) called up (d) called on

2) Please _____ the form carefully before you submit it.

(a) fill in (b) fill up on
(c) fill away (d) fill after

3) The thief _____ with the necklace.

(a) made off (b) made up
(c) made out (d) made into

4) We must _____ our plan until next week.

(a) put off (b) put on

(c) put in (d) put to

5) He _____ the idea that the world is flat.

(a) gave up (b) gave over

(c) gave out (d) gave off

II. Attempt any 4 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. **(4x1=4)**

6) Choose the correct conjunction: He was tired _____ he kept working.

(a) so (b) but

(c) because (d) or

7) Choose the correct pronoun: Ravi and _____ went to the museum.

(a) me (b) I

(c) myself (d) mine

8) 'Neither of the boys are present' is grammatically correct.

(State True or False.)

9) Choose the correct word. Each of the students _____ a book. (has / have) *(has / have)*

10) Choose the sentence in which the subject agrees with the verb.

(a) The children plays outside. (b) The news are shocking.

(c) The team is winning. (d) Two kilometres are a long way.

III. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. **(3x1=3)**

11) _____ I borrow your pen, please?

(a) Shall (b) May

(c) Must (d) Would to

12) Fill in with a modal: You _____ not park here; it is a no-parking zone. (should / must)

13) 'Can' is used to show ability.

(State True or False.)

14) Choose the sentence that shows advice.

(a) You must be on time. (b) You should drink more water.

(c) You can swim. (d) You may go now.

IV. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. **(3x1=3)**

15) Choose the correct sentence.

(a) Me and him went shopping. (b) He and I went shopping.

(c) Him and me went shopping. (d) Myself and he went shopping.

16) Fill in the blank with a pronoun. The students did _____ homework on time.

17) 'Which' can be used as a relative pronoun for things.

(State True or False.)

18) Choose the conjunction: She stayed at home _____ she was ill.

(a) because (b) beside

(c) although is (d) ever

SECTION C — WRITING (12 Marks) — 12 marks

Q4. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) As the Secretary of the Eco Club, write a notice in about 50 words for the notice board informing students about a tree-plantation drive on 2 January. Mention date, time, venue and what students should bring.

O R

(B) Write a diary entry in 100–120 words about your visit to a historical monument (fort, palace or stepwell). Mention what you saw, learned and felt.

Q5. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) You are Meera/Manav of 12 Gandhi Road, Jaipur. Write a letter to the Station Master complaining about the poor condition of the railway platform at your local station. Suggest improvements. (100–120 words)

O R

(B) Write a letter to your friend living in another city, describing how you celebrated the festival of Diwali this year. (100–120 words)

SECTION D — LITERATURE (20 Marks) — 20 marks

Q6. Read the following passage and answer any four out of the five questions that follow: **(4x1=4)**

> Tenali Ramakrishna was a poet and court jester at the court of King Krishnadevaraya of Vijayanagara. His wit was famous. When the king once asked him to bring the 'most useful thing', Tenali brought a simple bowl of water; he explained that no life could exist without it. The king laughed and rewarded him. Tenali's jokes always carried a lesson and he never used his cleverness to hurt anyone innocent.

a) Tenali Ramakrishna was a court _____ at Vijayanagara. (jester / soldier) *(jester / soldier)*

b) Tenali brought a bowl of water as the most useful thing.
(State True or False.)

c) Why did Tenali choose water?
(a) It was cheap
(b) No life could exist without it
(c) The king was thirsty
(d) It was sacred only

d) Tenali's jokes always carried:
(a) a danger
(b) a lesson
(c) an insult
(d) a prize

e) What do you learn about Tenali's character from the extract?

Q7. Read the following extract and answer any two out of the three questions that follow: **(2x2=4)**

The moon peeps through the window pane
And silvers all the room;
The night wind sings a soft refrain
And chases off the gloom.

a) What does the moon do?

b) What does the night wind do?

c) Pick out a pair of rhyming words from the extract.

Q8. Answer any four out of the five questions given below. **(4x3=12)**

a) What qualities of Major Somnath Sharma would you like to develop in yourself? Give reasons.

b) How did Verghese Kurien's work change the lives of farmers in Kaira?

c) Describe one incident that shows Tenali's presence of mind.

d) How does the poet make us feel sympathy for the old woman in 'Somebody's Mother'?

e) Why is helping others an important value? Support your answer with examples from any two lessons.